# Making Comparisons

Compare lines precisely, so the examiner sees you understand the data.

## Like with like

Both sides of *than* or *compared with* must be the same kind of thing: a figure with a figure.

Northport was higher than Easton's water use.
Water use in Northport was higher than in Easton.
Westvale's figure was much lower than **that of** Northport.

*That of* = the figure of. *Those of* = the figures of.

## Multiples and fractions

**Divide before you write.**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 180 and 45 | 180 ÷ 45 = 4 | four times as high as |
| 150 and 60 | 150 ÷ 60 = 2.5 | two and a half times |
| 45 and 150 | 45 ÷ 150 = 0.3 | just under a third |
| 45 and 95 | 45 ÷ 95 ≈ 0.47 | just under half |

Not exact? Use *roughly, almost, just under, just over*.

## Comparing change over time

- *Water use in Easton rose faster than in Northport, increasing by 60 litres compared with 30.*
- Being higher is not the same as rising faster.
- **The gap:** subtract at the start and the end. It **widened** (grew) or **narrowed** (got smaller).

## Crossovers, peaks and lowest points

- **overtook**: the rising line went above. *Gas overtook coal between 2008 and 2012.*
- **fell below**: the falling line went under.
- **peaked at** 42% in 2012 · **reached its lowest point**, 12%, in 2020

Give the period of a crossover, not one year, unless the lines meet on a point.

## Useful comparison structures

- X was more / less ___ than Y
- X was not as ___ as Y
- Both X and Y ___, but ___
- While X ___, Y ___
- Compared with X's figure, Y's was ___
- X had the highest figure, followed by Y, while Z's was by far the lowest.

## Only compare what matters

Compare start and end points, crossovers, peaks, lowest points and the gap. Skip single middle values and anything that isn't in the graph.